

WEBSITE PROPOSAL

EmpowerHer

Empowering Women in Technology

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1. Organisation Overview

Organisation Name	EmpowerHer
Founded	2025
Founder & CEO	Kuhle Mbono
Type	Non-profit org

Brief History

EmpowerHer was founded in 2025 by Kuhle Mbono in response to the persistent gender gap in South Africa's technology sector. Recognising that many women are interested in tech careers but lack accessible entry points and support structures, Kuhle built EmpowerHer as a central online platform that curates free learning resources, and fosters a community of like-minded professionals..

Mission Statement

To provide accessible, beginner-friendly resources and build a strong support network of women in tech empowering women at all stages of their technology careers.

Vision Statement

To bridge the gender gap in tech by empowering women through learning, mentorship, and community support, creating a future where women are equally represented at all levels of the technology sector.

Target Audience

EmpowerHer serves three primary audience groups:

- Women pursuing careers in technology including students, recent graduates, and working professionals at all levels
- Industry professionals and experienced tech workers looking to mentor and uplift the next generation of women in tech
- Companies and organisations advocating for diversity, equity, and inclusion in the technology sector

2. Website Goals and Objectives

Primary Goals

- Serve as a central hub for women in tech, offering curated learning resources, mentorship access, and community connection
- Increase awareness of EmpowerHer's programs and attract new members to the platform
- Facilitate sign-ups for the mentorship program and upcoming events
- Build a credible, professional online presence that attracts corporate sponsors and partner organisations
- Provide a community space where women can share experiences, find support, and grow together

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

KPI	Target
Monthly website visitors	500+ within 6 months of launch
Mentorship programme sign-ups	50+ applications per intake
Slack community members	200+ active members within 3 months
Event registrations	30+ per event
Bounce rate	Below 55%
Average time on site	3+ minutes

3. Proposed Website Features and Functionality

Essential Pages

- Homepage: hero section, Donate CTA.
- About Us: founding story (2025), mission, vision
- Programs: Introduction to frontend development, introduction to ux/ui etc
- Resources & Insights: searchable blog with category tags (Inspiration, Interview, Mentorship); articles with author and date
- Events: upcoming events list with date, time, title, description, and Register Now buttons;
- Contact / Join Us: sign-up form for new members and enquiry form for sponsors and partners

Additional Functionality

- Sticky navigation bar with smooth scroll and active section highlighting
- Slack community integration button linking directly to the EmpowerHer workspace
- Newsletter sign-up form for monthly updates and event notifications
- Mobile-first responsive design for all screen sizes
- Dynamic events calendar to automatically update and archive past events
- Social media links (LinkedIn, Instagram, Twitter/X) in header and footer
- Footer with quick links, contact details, and copyright information
- Basic SEO optimisation meta tags, alt text on all images, and semantic HTML structure

4. Design and User Experience

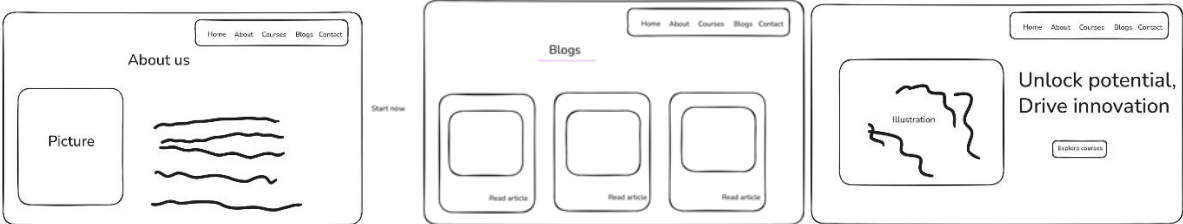
Design Aesthetic and Branding

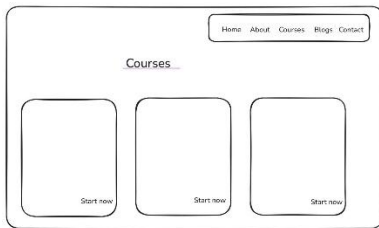
EmpowerHer's design is bold, modern, and purposefully feminine without being exclusive. The existing website already establishes a strong visual identity that should be maintained and refined in the final build. The use of deep purple/navy paired with a vibrant pink accent creates a confident, professional look that sets EmpowerHer apart from generic educational platforms.

Colour Scheme	Primary: Deep navy/purple (#2D1B69) Accent: Hot pink (#C2185B) Secondary: Soft lavender (#F3E8FF) Background: Light grey-white (#FAFAFA)
Typography	Headings: Bold sans-serif (e.g., Inter or Poppins) large, impactful Body: Regular weight, 11–12pt for readability Accent text: Pink for key labels and CTAs
Layout and Design	Multi-page layout with full-width hero sections Card-based layouts for programs, community spaces, and blog posts Clean white backgrounds with lavender section breaks

User Experience Considerations

- Navigation: Sticky top navbar on desktop; hamburger menu on mobile for clean browsing
- Layout: Consistent section spacing, clear visual hierarchy, and full-width imagery for impact
- Colour scheme: High-contrast text against light backgrounds; pink accents used sparingly to draw attention to CTAs
- Mobile: Mobile-first design with stacked columns on small screens
- Accessibility: Alt text on all images, sufficient colour contrast, and keyboard-navigable menus in line with WCAG 2.1 guidelines
- Community feel: Real photography of women in tech throughout, not just stock illustrations
- Resources Page: Search bar | Category filter tabs | Article cards with image, category tag, title, and excerpt
- Events Page: Upcoming events list with date, time, title, description, and Register Now button
- Footer: Logo | Quick links | Contact email | Social media icons | Copyright





5. Technical Requirements

Hosting and Domain

- Current hosting: Netlify (free tier) suitable for initial launch and student project phase
- Custom domain registration via afrihost or Namecheap estimated R150–R300/year

Programming Languages and Frameworks

- HTML5: semantic page structure and accessibility compliance
- CSS3: styling, layout, colour scheme, animations, and responsive design
- JavaScript: interactive features: mobile menu, smooth scrolling, event registration, form validation
- Community: Slack API integration for community hub connection
- Forms: Formspree for contact and sign-up form submissions

6. Timeline and Milestones

Phase	Milestone / Deliverable	Target Date
Phase 1	Proposal document completed and submitted	Week 1–2
Phase 2	Low-fidelity wireframes reviewed and finalised	Week 2–3
Phase 3	HTML/CSS structure coded for all pages	Week 3–5
Phase 4	JavaScript interactivity added (nav, forms, filters)	Week 5–6
Phase 5	Responsive design testing across devices and browsers	Week 6–7
Phase 6	Content population, imagery, and final copy	Week 7–8
Phase 7	Final review, bug fixes, and submission	Week 8

7. Budget

Item	Est. Cost (R)	Frequency
Domain registration (.co.za or .org.za)	R150 – R300	Annual
Netlify hosting (free tier)	R0	Free / Monthly
SSL Certificate	R0 (Netlify included)	Free
Slack workspace (free plan)	R0	Free
Content & maintenance (ongoing)	R0 – R500/month	Monthly

8. References

The following sources informed the content, recommendations, and technical specifications presented in this proposal:

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